



UI Center for the Book

Book Arts Research Database



Search 

Glossary

All terms used in the database listed here and defined. Links take you to Opening Artist Books (OAB), a website developed by collaborators at the J. Willard Marriott Library, University of Utah, who has graciously agreed to collaborate with us on this aspect of BARD. The OAB provides definitions as well as related terms and additional sources. Terms not in the OAB are defined below. In addition, for some terms we expand upon the OAB term or provide links to other on-line sources.

Terms are grouped by the categories in the search function and within those categories, in alphabetical order. There are, of course, terms or concepts that be in two categories, as noun and verb (print, printing). We include the majority of these types of terms in Process/Technique as an activity over the resulting object.

Naming is complex and not absolute. After years of coming up against that complexity, we now choose work with the ambiguities. As this project originates at the University of Iowa Center for the Book, there are occasions when we default to usage developed or evolving out of our faculty and student research. We

acknowledge the merit to shared terminology and also the accompanying limitations.

Materials

Binder's Board

A formulated compressed cardboard produced specifically for bookbinding. A range of density, depth, and quality is used and is available.

Bone

Animal bone--used for book clasps and other forms of adornment or inclusion in books and book art work.

Book Cloth

Cloth formulated for used in book binding. A variety of cloth is produced using different fabrics and production techniques. Some are sized and some are backed with paper.

Bosses

Protective fittings, usually of metal but also, occasionally, of wood or bone fixed to the exterior surface of a board to protect the covering material...In some cases, their use was as much, if not more, decorative than practical, and they could be used to confer status on a binding, especially after the

sixteenth century. They were usually fitted towards the four corners of the board, but a fifth boss will often be found in the centre of the board.

(Language of Bindings)

https://www.ligatus.org.uk/lob/search?search_api_fulltext=boss

Clasps



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/clasps/

Clay



A material made up earthy particles that is malleable when wet and hardens when fired.

Cord



A material made by twisting together twisted strands of vegetable fibres to provide a material of a thickness suitable for either a sewing support or endband core, the former often being referred to as sewing cords. Cord is typically made from a variety of bast fibres the most common of which on early bindings will be jute, flax (linen) and hemp. (Language of Bindings)

https://www.ligatus.org.uk/lob/search?search_api_fulltext=cord

Decorative Paper



A variety of processes used to embellish papers used in bookbinding, both for covers and endpapers. Processes include paste papers, marbling, and stamping.

Dyes



A colorant that is chemically bonded to the substrate being colored. Historically dyes were made from a wide range of plant and some animal materials, practices that continue today. Synthetic dyes, formulated in the 20th century, are made from petro-chemicals.

Fabric



Cloth made from a wide range of fibers by means of felting, weaving, or knitting.

Faux Leather



Faux leather is one of several names given to artificial or synthetic leather.

Found Object/s



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/found-object/

Found Text



A found text takes an existing text (a poem, a newspaper article, a grocery list, any preexisting text) and puts it into a new context to create a new, intentional piece of writing.

Glass



A hard, brittle substance, typically transparent or translucent, made by fusing sand with soda, lime, and sometimes other ingredients and cooling rapidly.

Gold Leaf



Refers to sheets of gold that have been hammered or rolled very thin (typically around 0.1 micrometer, or 4 millionths of an inch, thick). In art, gold leaf has been applied to paintings, sculptures, manuscripts, and decorative arts since around 1500 BCE. In the 1920s, the process of creating gold leaf was successfully automated. (Library of Bindings)

https://www.ligatus.org.uk/lob/search?search_api_fulltext=gold+leaf

Graphite



A soft black lustrous form of carbon that conducts electricity and is used in lead pencils and electrolytic anodes, as a lubricant, and as a moderator in nuclear reactors.

Source: Webster's Dictionary

Handmade Paper



Paper made from pulps of plant and cloth fibers, created by using a variety of non-mechanized methods. (see papermaking formation below)

Ink



A liquid of varied thicknesses and composition used for writing, drawing, painting and printing. May include ingredients such as pigments, dyes, charcoal, alcohol, soot, iron gall, gum arabic, etc.

Leather



The skin of an animal, with the hair removed, prepared for use by tanning or a similar process designed to preserve it against decay and make it pliable or supple when dry.

Machine-made Paper



Paper made using industrial processes and machinery in both fiber preparation and sheet formation. Methods include the cylinder mould machine still used to create mould-made papers, machines based on the Fourdrinier machine developed in the 18th c.

<https://www.sciencedirect.com/topics/engineering/fourdrinier>

Mould-made Paper



Paper made by machine that simulates qualities of handmade paper. The mold is a rotating cylinder that picks up pulp from the vat, and couches it onto a moving woolen felt.

Magnet/s



Metal with a strong attraction to another metal object, producing a magnetic field, attracting or repelling like or unlike poles. In the book arts, generally use as a closure.

Metal



A solid material that is typically hard, shiny, malleable, fusible, and ductile, with good electrical and thermal conductivity (e.g., iron, gold, silver, copper, and aluminum, and alloys such as brass and steel).

Mixed Media



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/mixed-media/

Natural Materials (sticks, rocks, flora...)



Raw materials or items found in nature including leaves, flowers, branches, ice, soil, sand, stone, and water.



Paint (acrylic, gouache, watercolor)

A liquid material consisting of a pigment suspended in a binder or other vehicle that when dry binds the pigment to the surface on which it is applied.

Papyrus

A writing material prepared from thin strips of the pith of papyrus plant laid together, soaked, pressed, and dried, originally used by the ancient Egyptians, Greeks, and Romans.

Parchment

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/parchment/

Paste Paper

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/paste-papers/

Pigments

A colorant that is not soluble in water (as opposed to a dye). Pigments are particles suspended in a medium and require that medium to attach to a surface material.

Plastics (acrylic, acetate, plexiglass)

A synthetic material made from a wide range of organic polymers such as polyethylene, PVC, nylon, etc., that can be molded into shape while soft and then set into a rigid or slightly elastic form.

Ribbon



A woven strip or band of fine material, as silk or rayon, varying in width and finished off at the edges.

Sticker/s



An adhesive label of varying size.

Thread



Thread is a tightly twisted strand made of two or more plies of yarn (a collection of fibers used to weave or knit) that are circular when cut in cross section.

Wax



A hard substance that becomes soft when it is heated and that is used to make various products. Varieties of wax include beeswax, lanolin, vegetable, and petroleum.



Wood

An organic material made up of cellulose fibers, wood makes up the trunks or main stems of trees and shrubs.

Wooden Boards

Cover boards used in certain styles of bookbinding including Ethiopian, Coptic, and European historical methods.

Papermaking Fiber: Abaca

Papermaking Fiber: Bark (not pulped)

Papermaking Fiber: Cotton linter or half-stuff

Papermaking Fiber: Flax

Papermaking Fiber: Gampi

Papermaking Fiber: Hemp

Papermaking Fiber: Mitsumata

Papermaking Fiber: Paper Mulberry (Kozo / Dak)

Papermaking Fiber: Textiles (linen, cotton, hemp)

Papermaking Fiber: Recycled Papers

Papermaking Fiber: Mix

Papermaking Fiber: Sulfite/Wood

Papermaking Fiber: Other

Process/Technique

Blind Embossing/Debossing



Blind embossing/debossing refers to inkless impressions.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/emboss/

Blind Tooling



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/blind-tooling/

Blow-outs (hand papermaking)



A papermaking technique for image creation in which a certain portion of a freshly pulled sheet couched onto a base sheet is masked off by a stencil while the rest of the pulp is removed by pressured water spray.

Chine-collé



A process in which an image is printed onto a very thin sheet of paper, often an Asian-style sheet. The thinner sheet is run through the press simultaneously with a heavier sheet underneath, with the two sheets bonding during the printing process. This process allows for fine details in addition to texture and/or color coming through from the base sheet.

Collage



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/collage/

Collagraph/Sandragraph



A Sandragraph is a specific form of collagraph devised by Harry Reese for proof press printing. He describes it as a low-relief collagraphic printmaking procedure in which prints are made directly from type high blocks on which the surfaces created reliefs have been covered by cloth and acrylic polymer.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/collagraph/

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/sandragraph/

Cyanotype/Blue Printing



Blue printing refers to a photographic process using iron salts and producing an image in Prussian blue. Cyanotype refers to using this process for photographic images (rather than blue print drafting plans, etc).

Die-cutting



Cutting out or removing material to create an image, shape, or text by means of a die, a metal piece that is used to cut out the material. Dies can be managed with pressure on a flat-bed press or work on rotary presses by using a rolling die that rolls across the material to be cut.

Digital Printing



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/digital-print/

Drawing



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/drawing/

Embossing



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/emboss/

Engraving



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/engraving/

Erasure



Erasure is a form in which the writer begins with an existing text and removes or erases portions of the text, creating a new work from that text. The new piece may be in dialog with the original text, a confirmation or rebuttal. It can also simply be a canvas from which to begin. In both poetry and the book arts, usually the visual result is an essential component of how the new work is read.

Etching



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/etching/

Gelatin Printing



Evolving from hectography, a gelatin plate-based reproductive technique prevalent in the 20th century, gelatin printing has been adapted by artists as a low-tech printmaking method. A plate is created from gelatin on which inks or paints can be applied and drawn into. Flat objects or stencils can also be placed on the plate and inked over. Paper is then laid on top, transferring the image from the plate to the paper. The plate can also be used with hectograph matrices, currently primarily used by tattoo artists. The matrix transfers an image to the gelatin plate from which multiple prints can be pulled.

Hand-coloring



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/hand-coloring/

Handlettering/Handwriting



The term calligraphy comes from the Greek kalligraphia meaning 'beautiful writing'. BARD refers to handlettering or calligraphy as both traditional or historic hands and contemporary works created by lettering artists. With the term handwriting, we refer to the untrained or usual hand employed by the artist.

Hand Papermaking Formation: Dipping or Puling (with a mould & deckle)



A mould and deckle, sugeta, or other equivalent piece of equipment is submerged into a vat filled with slurry (water + pulp). The sheet is formed, whether by a single dip or multiple dips (the latter often, but not always, having a formation aid to assist with dispersion and to slow drainage), and then couched. Couching is typically onto a post with other sheets of paper, or in between felts or another type of interfacing. Sometimes standalone sheets are couched (on a felt, interfacing, or even another, finer screen) so that the artist may further manipulate the paper's surface, as with many contemporary processes. The paper is often, pressed to release excess water. Drying methods vary greatly, i.e., restraint drying and board drying, each of them greatly effecting the surface feel of the final sheet.

Hand Papermaking Formation: Laminating/Beating (not pulped)

Fiber is laid out onto a smooth surface (whether in a grid or into evenly placed rows) and then beaten into a substrate form. The fibers gradually flatten out and coalesce into a sheet of paper. This form is then typically left to air-dry.

Hand Papermaking Formation: Pouring (into a mould or deckle box)

Pulp and/or slurry is poured into a structure such as a deep-framed screen or a deckle box, as opposed to being submerged into a vat. The sheet is either couched with other papers in a post or left to air-dry within the screen. For the latter method, the sheet is peeled from the screen when completely dry.

Hand Papermaking Formation: Floating (a mould)

A vat is filled with water, but not pulp. A single screen is placed in the water, wherein it floats. The papermaker adds desired amount of pulp and uses their fingers to disperse the fibers, sometimes also with the help of a formation aid to slow drainage and promote dispersion. The screen is lifted from the vat, at which point water drains and the pulp coalesces into a sheet of paper. The paper is air-dried, sometimes around heat (a fire), and then peeled from the mould once it has dried.

Handprinting (Baren, Spoon)

Images that are formed by transfer from one surface or source to another, and that are usually created with ink and produced in multiple impressions. Handprinting refers to transfer methods achieved without a press, for example, a baren or spoon.

Hectography/Spirit Duplication



Process used especially for copying letters, invented in the 19th century, in which writing or drawing made with aniline dye is transferred to a prepared gelatin surface from which a number of copies can be made; eventually replaced by spirit duplicating a printing process utilizing master sheets that release color through type indentations when a colorless chemical fluid is applied.

Source: AAT

Hot Stamping



Hot stamping (or foil stamping) is a method of printing in which a relief image, usually formed in metal, or type is transferred in foil to a printing surface by means of heat and pressure. In bookbinding this is generally used on book covers or spines. Foils come in a range of colors in with matte and glossy finishes.

Illustration



The process of creating a drawing, sketch, painting, photograph, or other image making process meant to elucidate a description, concept, or story, often in response to written material.

Inclusions

Materials, usually fairly flat, that are embedded between two surfaces, often paper. In hand papermaking, securing inclusions can be accomplished by various methods, sandwiching material between two sheets that are bonded together in the papermaking process.

Inkjet Printing

A digital non-impact printing process in which a series of nozzles spray tiny droplets of ink onto paper. Paper surface affects print quality as softer uncoated papers absorb and thus spread or feather. With coated papers, the ink sits on the surface and retain their form and thus, sharpness of the final image.

Intaglio Printing

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/intaglio-print/

Laser Cutting/CNC cutting

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/laser-cutting/

Letterpress Printing (image) ^

Relief printing from various type-high blocks, historically stereotypes, electrotypes, wood blocks, and later by the introduction of linoleum, rubber and plastic plates.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/letterpress-print/

Letterpress Printing (type) ^

Relief printing from metal types, wood type, polymer and metal plates.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/letterpress-print/

Linoleum Block Printing ^

A form of relief printing using a sheet of linoleum, which is carved away using gouges, chisels or knives. The remaining un-carved areas result in a raised positive image that is inked up to create a print, either by hand or using a press.

Lithography ^

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/lithograph/

Marbling

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/marbling/

Monoprinting

Printing done on an etched flat plate on which paints or inks are applied and a print taken. Each print is singular in that a new application of medium is applied for each print but the etched matrix remains throughout the series of prints.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/monoprint/

Monotyping

Printing using a smooth flat plate onto which inks are applied and manipulated to create an image from which a print is pulled. These are unique prints made without a matrix, though any remaining ink can serve as a ghost of the original image.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/monotype/

Offset Lithography

A commercial printing process used in industry throughout the 20th and into the 21st century. A planographic process, the image is transferred from a roller or plate to a rubber blanket or roller and from there onto the paper. Offset presses are primarily used printing high runs. In the 1980s and 90s,

smaller offset presses were obtained and used by book artists, often in collective shops, to print experimental works utilizing this technology.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/offset-prints/

Paper Cutting (by hand)



Paper, or another substrate, folded and cut with scissors, or laid flat and cut with blades, punches, or gouges to create designs. Many cultures and regions have a rich history of paper cutting. Finished designs / images / text may be made from a single sheet of paper or multiple layered sheets. In book arts paper cutting is often used to create the image narratives in tunnel books or carousel books.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/cutout/

Paste Papers



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/paste-papers/

Photography



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/photograph/

Photopolymer (image)



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/photopolymer-print/

Photopolymer (type)



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/photopolymer-print/

Pochoir



A stencil process for making colored prints or adding color to printed illustrations; usually a monochrome print is hand-colored by the use of multiple stencils. Pochoir was most popular from the late 19th century through the 1930s, centered in Paris, and is often associated with the Art Deco and Art Nouveau movements. It was often used to create images for French fashion, textile and interior decoration portfolios and journals; and also used for prints and images in books. Historically, stencils were made of thin sheets of metal, such as copper or zinc, or made celluloid. Today, stencils are often cut in mylar or other stiff polymer. Pigments are applied with brushes. Gouache was often used as it allows for brilliant, rich colors and crisp, clean edges.

Pressure Printing



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/pressure-print/

Pulp Painting (Pulp Imaging)



In papermaking, the use of pulp as a painting or drawing medium on either freshly pulled sheets or as stand-alone pieces.

Pulp Printing



In papermaking, the use of very finely beaten pulp that can be used to press through a screen onto a freshly pulled sheet.

Relief Printing



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/relief-print/

Reprographic Printing (Photocopy/Laser)



Photocopy: General term for copies produced by photocopying, that is, in a machine employing a light-sensitive process, and usually at a one-to-one scale. In the early to mid-20th century, used regarding copies made by various specific processes; since the mid-20th century, most often refers to xerographic copies.

Laser Print: Prints on photographic materials achieved by controlled exposure to white, red, green, or blue light and processed chemically. Distinguished from 'electrophotographic laser prints' that create images via a beam of light to etch onto a photoconductive drum from which images are transferred by electrostatic copying to paper.

Source: The Getty Thesaurus of Art & Architecture

Risograph Printing



Trademarked term for a particular type of digital duplicating machine made by the Riso company that employs soy-based inks. Copies are created by scanning an image, burning it to a laser-etched stencil that is wrapped around a drum containing ink that rolls over continuously fed paper to create copies very rapidly.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/risographs/

Source: The Getty Thesaurus of Art & Architecture

Screen Printing



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/silkscreen/

Stamping (by hand)



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/stamp-prints/

Stenciling



A print process that uses images cut into a piece of metal, plastic, or other unabsorbent material, or burned onto a screen to create an image area. The stencil is placed on top of a substrate—for example, paper—and then ink is brushed, sprayed, scraped, or otherwise applied to the surface.

Suminagashi

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/marbling/

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/suminagashi/

Trace Monoprinting

A print process in which paper is laid down on an inked smooth surface. Then a drawing is made on the exposed side of the paper, pressing the paper against the ink, creating the inked image.

Transfers

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/image-transfer/

Typesetting: Digital

Arranging type into a body of text. Digital typesetting originated in the late 20th century. Typesetting utilizes digitally designed faces which are widely available for digital composition accomplished on computers with software such as the Adobe Creative Suite and Microsoft Word.

Typesetting: Metal

Arranging type into a body of text. Typesetting in metal is done by hand, arranging individual characters or sorts; or, by machine, in which characters

are cast either as individual sorts or lines of type.

Typesetting: Wood



Arranging type into a body of text. Generally designed for display, wood type is set by arranging individual characters or sorts. Words carved as one block are also found, usually for advertising purposes. Wood type is used for larger sizes.

Watermark/s



Marks or images formed in hand papermaking. The form that creates the watermark is made from a range of materials from wire to paper to foam. The form is attached to the paper mold, preventing pulp from settling in that area when the sheet is formed. This area of thinner pulp, shows the image when held up to the light.

Wood Engraving



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/wood-engraving/

Woodblock Printing



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/woodcuts/

Other

Terms not included in the list of search terms that researchers deem relevant will be added to an 'other' category. These terms can be searched using the keyword function.

Hand Papermaking Traditions

The history of papermaking techniques and traditions is a fluid and difficult to codify path. Many windings, interactions and crossings of cultures, shifts in geographic identities, and concurrent developments make any definitive definitions problematic. The desire to specifically name and place a particular method or tradition is counter to most any historical tracking of craft traditions, but also a when building a database. We have chosen to include this section of named traditions to acknowledge that paper has been and is being made almost everywhere. Almost every method is practiced in places beyond its beginnings and every method has evolved. We describe major methods in the process section of the database. Here we recognize the many cultures with historically identifiable traditions as well as newly revived or innovated processes. While we likely have few items in the collection we are working with that contain papers made in Cambodia or with fibers grown in South America, we know that those examples exist and should be included in any exploration of papermaking history. We also know that our abilities to accurately identify papers are more limited than those present in the collection. Thus, the options for both broad and narrower definitions—for example, if we know a paper was made utilizing a European style, but that was made in Canada, we attribute it to that style and also North America as a location of production. If we know a paper was made with paper mulberry and formed in vat, but are not sure if it comes from China or Japan, we note that it is likely an Asian style, but not where it was made or any specifics on papermaking tradition. We know this is less than ideal, but offer this as a step in teasing out

specificity while also recognizing the trails and connections that tie these myriad traditions together. We also welcome all and any feedback and suggestions for better reflecting this aspect of attribution from our users.

Structure/Physical Format

Accordion

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/accordion/

Accordion Variations

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/accordion-variations/

Album

A book designed and bound to accommodate the addition of photographs, stamps, or pictures. or memorabilia. Many contemporary methods for creating albums originate for bindings devised in the second half of the nineteenth century.

Altered Book

A book created by using an existing book to create a new work of art. The original book is transformed through cutting, collage, painting, sanding, adhering, sewing, etc. etc. The new book—that is, the now altered book—is often very different in form and content than the original source book.

Sometimes the book is altered to make a commentary or reflection on the original subject or form of the book, or is an artistic exploration into the subject or form of the book.

Belly Band/s



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/belly-bands/

Boustrophedon/Meander



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/boustrophedon/

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/meander-book/

Broadside



Historically, the broadside, or broadsheet, was a single sheet of paper (folded or not), that contained information, proclamations, opinions, or ballads. Often, the sheet was printed on only one side. The term also refers to a literary genre. In this context, a broadside features a poem or an excerpt from a prose piece and is often accompanied by an image. Often literary broadsides are created to commemorate a poet's reading, or a special event.

Carousel Book



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/carousel-book/

Case Binding

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/case-binding/

Compound Structure

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/concertina/

Concertina**Dos-a-dos**

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/dos-a-dos/

Double Pamphlet

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/double-pamphlet/

Drum Leaf Binding

Note: BARD would make a distinction here in that the drum-leaf does not necessarily require stiff leaves. Examples can be found utilizing thin and flexible folios.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/drum-leaf-binding/

Endhands

A decorative and/or structurally functional band attached at the head and tail of a bookblock atop the folds at the spine. Endbands may be sewn or made of materials such as cloth, paper, or leather wrapped around a core.

Exposed Sewing

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/exposed-spine-binding/

Flag Book

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/flag-book/

Flexagon

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/flexagon/

Flip Book

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/flip-book/

Fold-out/s

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/fold-out/

Folios (loose, unsewn)

Sheets of paper folded in half. In book arts, grouped unsewn folios often comprise a set of prints or other content.

French-fold

Single sheet folded in half and then again in the opposite direction resulting in a folio that once opened can then fold up revealing the inner surface. This form allows for printing 4 pages on one side only or for creating a fold-out with content revealed only when opened out.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/french-fold/

Gatefold

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/gatefold/

Hard Cover (binder's board/wood, etc.)

Rigid book covers made up of: binder's board, wood, laminated papers or cartonnage, metal, plexi-glass, or other rigid material.

Jacob's Ladder

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/jacobs-ladder/

In-Boards Binding



Bindings in which the boards are attached to the bookblock by various means before the book is covered. Such books are also described as 'bound in boards'. (Language of Bindings)

Japanese Multi-Section Binding



The tetsuyōsō or tetchōsō (multisection) binding is also known as retsujōsō. Sheets of paper are stacked on one another in sets of approximately five and folded in two to form a fascicle (the folding is called ori). More sets are added as needed; holes are opened along the creases, covers are added on both sides and thread is passed through the holes to bind sets and covers together.

Laced-on/Laced-in Binding



Methods of attaching in-boards bindings, which sewing supports are laced through the cover boards prior to covering the book.

Lapped Case/Three Piece Binding



The three-piece case consists of two boards joined by a spine-piece of thick paper, cartonnage or thin millboard, creating a primary cover which may then have a secondary cover, usually coloured and often decorated, adhered over it. This method provides for a thinner flexible spine-piece that allows the book to open while also having a rigid cover boards.

<https://www.ligatus.org.uk/lob/concept/1665>

Limp Paper/Paper Case Binding



A European style dating back to the fifteenth century consisting of a bookblock sewn on supports which are then laced into a stiff paper cover, serving as the primary cover to text attachment. The lacings become a visible element of the binding.

https://www.ligatus.org.uk/lob/search?search_api_fulltext=laced-case

Limp Vellum Binding



Vellum refers to parchment made of calf-skin. The structure follows the same process as limp paper bindings.

Link Stitch



Sometimes called a chain stitch, the link stitch is a type of unsupported sewing in which the sewing thread, as it emerges from an individual sewing station, passes down to link around the thread emerging from the station in previous gathering. This forms chains of thread across the spine at each sewing station.

Long & Link Stitch



Long and link bindings use both linking stitches that climb, attaching one section to the next) and long stitches that traverse the section along the spine. The cover is sewn to the book with the stitches exposed on the spine of the cover. The sewing can be simple and straightforward or quite decorative with elaborate shapes and secondary sewings employed. Long and link stitch books can use only long stitches, only link stitches, or a combination of the two. Both can also be found with an over-covering that hides the sewing.

Long Stitch



See Long & Link stitch

Loose Sheets



Single sheets meant to be seen as a whole, boxed or otherwise arranged so as to function as a unified work.

Map Fold



A form of fold-out historically used to fold large maps to accommodate portability. The form is created from a single sheet of paper and encompasses a wide variety of folds.

Miniature Book



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/miniature-books/

Mobius Strip



A mobius strip, devised by two German mathematicians, is a single rectangular surface that when constructed has only one side. This is accomplished by giving one end of the strip a half-twist before attaching the ends together.

Moveable Element/s



Moveable elements in a book may include wheels (vovelles), lift flaps or pull tabs. They are activated by the viewer of a book. For a related but distinct form, see Pop-up elements.

Multi-section Binding



A text block consisting of two or more gatherings (also called sections, signatures, or quires), usually sewn through the folds, though sometimes adhered across the folds prior to adhering to a lining or cover.

Palm Leaf Binding



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/palm-leaf-book/



Pamphlet Binding

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/pamphlet-binding/

Perfect Binding



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/perfect-bindings/

Pop-up Elements



Pop-up elements are shapes, images, or objects that rise away from the base page spread of a book. They are animated by turning the page in a book. Pop-ups that are cut out of the base page itself transform from a flat folded sheet to a fully 3-dimensional shape at 90 degrees and lays flat again when open to 180 degrees. There are also pop-ups that are fully extended only when the book is open to 180 degrees; these are created by paper elements that have been added on to the base page. For a related but distinct form, see Moveable Elements.

Post Binding



Also called screw post, thesis, or Chicago binding. The pages and covers are attached by means of metal screw posts, allowing for the removal and addition of pages. Depending on the style of cover, the posts can be exposed or hidden. Post bindings are a modern adaptation of album style books developed in the 19th century, often held together with ribbon, rather than posts.

Postcard

Usually made of heavy paper stock, a card meant to be sent through the mail, usually with an image or group of images on one side and space for an address, stamp, and handwritten note on the other.

Poster

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/poster/

Saddle Stitch

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/saddle-stitch/

Scroll

Scrolls made from papyrus, parchment, leather, silk, or paper consist of rolls containing texts and images. A very early book form, scrolls have traditionally been used for many religious texts as well as sectarian documentation. Scrolls were employed by numerous cultures, from Ethiopian healing scrolls to Buddhist sutras to the Judaic Torah.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/scroll/

Sculptural Bookwork

Sculptural Bookwork highlights the physical form of books. Works created could take non-traditional forms, may include a grouping of books organized to create a sculptural form, or be altered in significant ways. Often these books engage with, question, and invite the viewer to change their preconceived assumptions about books.

Section



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/section/

Single-section Binding



Single section bindings encompass any book composed of a single set of nested folios bound at the fold.

Single-sheet Book



Book forms created from a single sheet of paper, often resulting in multiple pages in the form of an accordion fold or single section booklet.

Soft Cover



Covers made of flexible materials of varying rigidity. Typical materials include heavy papers, fabric, leather, parchment.



Spiral/Comb Binding

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/comb-binding/

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/spiral-binding/

Stab/Side-sewn



Other than Asian-style stab bindings, side sewn books are also used in mechanized or hand bookbinding in which single sheets or folio are sewn or stapled along the edge of the text block prior to covering.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/asian-stab-binding/

Stiff Leaf



Book consisting of individual rigid pages of heavy weight paper or board that are hinged together to create folios. Childrens' board books are a common form of this structure. In that example, the pages themselves also serve as the hinge. Other hinging methods are also employed. Historically associated with Victorian album structures in which photographs were sandwiched between two pages with windows that reveal the image.

Tunnel Book



Tunnel books, are created by attaching individual sheets of paper to successive folds of two concertina strips, one on the left and one on right hand side of each sheet. Cut out images allow viewers to see through from

the front to back of the book. Also called 'peep show books', the form goes back to the 18th c.

Turkish Map Fold



A specific map fold, also called the pop-out fold. Created from a single sheet of paper, when closed it resembles a simple house-shaped form. As it opens multiple folds appears and once fully open the full sheet is revealed. It is one of many map-folds created through various folding methods. Used in the tourist industry to make compact city maps, the elegance of the Turkish map fold has popularized it for book art works. The origin of the name has yet to be discovered.

Vovelle/Wheel



A moveable element originally used as a computational or reckoning device. The volvelle is made up of one or more rotating concentric circles. Cutout areas on the top wheel reveal different elements appearing below as the wheel is rotated. Usually made of paper, cardboard, or parchment and attached to book pages.

<https://museum.wales/blog/2044/Volvelles-early-paper-calculators/>

Source: AAT

Web-stitch/French Sewn Binding



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/french-link-stitch/

Wire-edge Binding

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/wire-edge-binding/

Other

Terms not included in the list of search terms that researchers deem relevant will be added to an 'other' category. These terms can be searched using the keyword function.

Enclosure

Clamshell/Drop-spine Box

Developed from the Solander box, designed in the 19th century. An enclosure designed to protect books consisting of two three-sided trays—the smaller fitting around the book, the second closing over the first— and a spine piece. The trays are hinged to a case with the open sides facing the spine piece. The box then opens out to lie flat. Many variations have developed from this basic form.

Envelope

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/envelope/

Four-flap Wrapper

A conservation-style enclosure employed by book artists, using decorative or printed materials.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/four-flap-enclosure/

Hinged-lid Box

Variations of this structure include a drop-spine style and a 3-walled tray.

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/hinged-lid-box/

Lidded Box

A box created with a tray and separate lid. Various lids include a flush lid supported by an inner lining, a 'shoe box' lid, and a recessed lid.

Portfolio

Two or four-flap enclosure made of binder's board or other rigid material, often covered with decorative paper, book cloth, or leather. Designed specifically for the enclosed object.

Slipcase

Enclosures that are open on one end to house a book or group of books. Commonly made of book board or heavy weight paper.

Wrapper (paper or card)

Any wrapper consisting of paper or other flexible materials. Commonly 2 or four-flap constructions.

Other

Terms not included in the list of search terms that researchers deem relevant will be added to an 'other' category. These terms can be searched using the keyword function.

Genre/Form

The terms we use to describe the genre/form of the book include both traditional literary genres as well as terms that allow us to be a bit more specific about the way text is being used/presented in artist books. The terms we have chosen also reflect some of the strengths/distinctiveness of our collection.

Abecedarium

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/abecedarium/

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/alphabet-book/

Biography

Biography is a sub-species of nonfiction in which the author of the text is someone other than its subject or central figure.

Catalogue

A book that is produced in conjunction with an exhibit and outlines the work in that exhibit. It often includes prefatory material such as an introduction, criticism or essays on the work.

Chapbook

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/chapbooks/

Comix/Comic Book

A bound collection, often printed in magazine format or perfect bound, of comic strips which are meant to be read sequentially. Comics feature hand-drawn, usually mass-produced, drawings and text and are often presented in frames. The term comix is used most often to refer to underground or alternative publications.

Cookbook

A book that contains recipes and instructions for cooking. The University of Iowa is the repository for the Szathmary Culinary Manuscripts and Cookbook Collection. Artist books make-up a portion of this collection.

Ephemera



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/ephemera/

Erasure



Erasure is a form in which the writer begins with an existing text and removes or erases portions of the text, creating a new work from that text. The new piece may be in dialogue with the original text, a confirmation or rebuttal. It can also simply be a canvas from which to begin. In both poetry and the book arts, usually the visual result is an essential component of how the new work is read.

Extracted Text



A text created through the selection of specific words, phrases, lines, sentences of a source text that is refashioned to create a wholly new text. Unlike many erasures, the resulting text does not reflect the material nature of the source text.

Fiction



Imaginative prose writing which can take a range of narrative forms including novels, novellas, short stories, flash fiction, etc.

Found Text

A found text takes an existing text (a poem, a newspaper article, a grocery list, any preexisting text) and puts it into a new context to create a new, intentional piece of writing.

Fragments

A fragment is a literary form which may be part of or suggestive of a larger text. These may be literal fragments, as in the incomplete remnants of ancient texts, such as a poem from Sappho; or, they are used to create an intentionally fragmented text that creates gaps, or tries to unsettle the expected.

Graphic Novel

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/graphic-novel/

Guidebook/Manual/Reference

Works in this genre give useful information to a reader. In artist's books, this form is often employed for artistic use—perhaps the information given is lyrical, personal or not generally useful in the traditional sense.

Index



Traditionally found at the back of a book, an index is an alphabetical list of topics, names, or concepts that can be found in the book. The index also includes the page numbers the topics can be found on in the book. Example: *Turning Leaves of Mind*, published by Granary Press.

List



The list is a literary form that marks discrete elements. Lists are crucial elements of ancient nonfiction forms like the pillow book, or can incorporate repetitions and emphases, as in the litany, can be a method for developing narrative, character, rhythm, and music.

Memoir



Non-fiction that recounts parts of an author's life.

Multiple-genre



This term refers to a work that contains more than one literary genre—for instance, a book that contains both poems and a short story.

Non-fiction



Prose writing other than fiction, such as history, biography, and reference works.

Performative Element



The term as put to use here refers specifically to books that have a theatrical element. Sometimes these book/objects were used in a piece of performance art; other times, they demand user interaction to be fully realized. Example: Doc/Undoc published by Moving Parts Press

Photo Bookwork



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/photobook/

Poetry



A literary text often said to include compression of words and intensity of emotions which can range from the lyrical to the narrative. Poems may be written in received forms which outline specific demands including the number of lines and the rhyme scheme (such as the sonnet or villanelle), or more contemporary forms such as free verse and prose poems.

Prose



Prose is any written work (including fiction, nonfiction, and technical or journalistic writing) that does not define itself by the features of poetry (rhyme, meter, poetic structure and form).

Trade



A book that is produced and published by a commercial publisher.

Wordless/Visual



https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/wordless-book/

Quotations



A work whose text is wholly comprised of or predominantly features quotations by other people.



Zine

https://oab.lib.utah.edu/artist_book_term/zine/

Other

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ABC of Bookbinding: An Illustrated Glossary of Terms for Collectors and Conservators, Jane Greenfield

How to Identify Prints: a Complete Guide to Manual and Mechanical Processes from Woodcut to Inkjet, Bamber Gascoigne

Bookbinding and the Conservation of Books: A Dictionary of Descriptive Terminology, Matt T. Roberts and Don Etherington

[Language of Bindings](#)

[Online Dictionary for Library and Information Science](#)

[The Book Arts Web](#)



Book Arts Research Database

UI Center for the Book

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